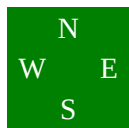


Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 2
♥ J 10 7 3
♦ A 6 4
♣ J 6 3

♠ K 6 5
♥ K Q
♦ K Q 8 2
♣ A 10 7 4



♠ Q 10 8 7 3
♥ 6 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ Q 9 5

♠ J 4
♥ A 9 8 5
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ K 8 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

You need 3 more tricks, and they must come from ♦s. So you must drive out the ♦A. The problem is that when the defenders win the ♦A they may also take 4 ♠ tricks.

This is another case where you should hold up. Allow EW to win the second trick and take your ♠K only at trick #3.

Now you drive out the ♦A. If East has it and also started with 5 ♠s you will go down. But if West has the ♦A you will make the contract no matter how ♠s split.

If you win the second ♠ West will still have a ♠ when he wins the ♦A.

But if you hold up your ♠K West will have no ♠ to put his partner in with.

Partner's 2♣ is Stayman convention. With no 4-card Major suit your response is 2♦. Partner now bids 2NT.

Partner's 2♣ is Stayman convention. With no 4-card Major suit your response is 2♦. Partner now bids 2NT.

The 2NT bid is invitational, asking you to bid game with a maximum, pass with a minimum. You have 17 points so you bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠7. You put on dummy's ♠J, but West wins the ♠A then continues with the ♠9. Do you play your ♠K now?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 6

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9
 ♥ 8 4 3
 ♦ K J 10 8 2
 ♣ J 10 4

♠ A 10 6 2
 ♥ Q 10 7 6
 ♦ 6 4
 ♣ 9 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 5
 ♥ A 2
 ♦ A 7 3
 ♣ A K Q 7 2

♠ J 7 4 3
 ♥ K J 9 5
 ♦ Q 9 5
 ♣ 8 5

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

First decide the holdup question. South led the ♥5 and you can see the ♥4, ♥3 and ♥2. Assuming South led fourth down he must have only a 4-card suit since there are no cards he could have lower than the ♥5. With ♥s splitting 4-4 a holdup would do no good, and isn't necessary anyway.

So take the ♥A. Then what?

You COULD try the ♦ finesse. Even if it loses it would establish several ♦ winners. However, if the defenders win just 1 ♦ trick they will quickly grab their 3 ♥ tricks and their ♠A and put you down 1.

This is why it is important to You need just one additional winner and all you have to do to get it is play a ♠ honor.

When you can see all four hands, including the location of the ♦Q, it kind of makes you wished you had finessed and gotten all those overtricks.

Good Bridge players like to take tricks, but they are not greedy.

Even if you wanted to show your ♦ suit how would you do it? If you bid 3♦ it would be a transfer and if you bid 4♦ you would have bypassed 3NT, your probable best contract.

But you didn't want to bid them anyway, you just wanted to bid 3NT, right?

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

South leads ♥5, North plays the ♥Q.

The first thing you need to decide is whether to hold up on the ♥.

Winner List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 5 :: Total = 8